

AUDIT EVIDENCE COLLECTION AND RETENTION SOP

Standard Operating Procedure | SOP No. SOP-AEC-012 | Version 3.3

SOP Number:	SOP-AEC-012
Version:	3.3
Effective Date:	July 11, 2024
Process Owner:	Michael Morrison (EMP-42659) — Senior Manager
Applicable System(s):	Audit Assistant Platform / ERP / Finance System

1. PURPOSE

This SOP defines the standardised process for audit evidence collection and retention to ensure consistency, control effectiveness, and audit traceability across all business units.

2. PROCESS FLOW

- 1
- Step 1: Auditor identifies source records relevant to the finding under review
- 2
- Step 2: Evidence extracted and logged with source_type and source_record_id
- 3
- Step 3: Alignment score calculated against the finding description
- 4
- Step 4: Evidence record linked to finding_id in the Evidence table
- 5
- Step 5: All evidence retained per the Record Retention Policy minimum period

3. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Role	Responsibility
AP Specialist	Initiates and validates process inputs
Finance Manager	Reviews and approves at designated control point
Compliance Officer	Performs periodic reconciliation and reporting
Risk Analyst	Performs periodic reconciliation and reporting

4. CONTROLS

This process incorporates the following key controls: (i) system-enforced validation against the Delegation of Authority Policy; (ii) mandatory documentation attachment prior to approval; (iii) periodic exception reporting to Internal Audit; and (iv) quarterly process effectiveness review.

5. EXCEPTION HANDLING

Any deviation from this SOP must be documented with justification and approved by Senior Manager or delegate. Exceptions are logged in the exception register and reviewed monthly by the Risk Committee. Repeated exceptions of the same type will trigger a process redesign review.

6. RELATED DOCUMENTS

This SOP should be read in conjunction with the Delegation of Authority Policy, the Internal Audit Charter, and the relevant functional policy governing this process area.